

EARTH CHANGERS

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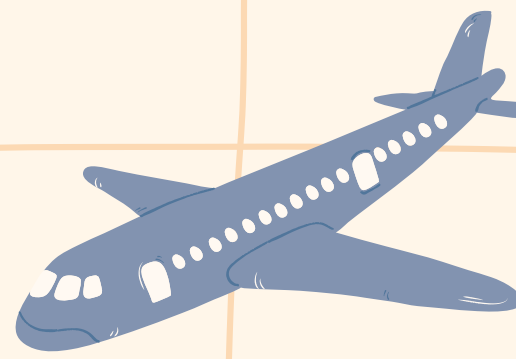




**What comes to your mind when you hear
“sustainable tourism”?**



★ The origin of the story - Industry predicament



- Traditional mass tourism = extractive development
- Profits taken by multinational giants
- Environment destroyed, culture commodified
- Local communities gain nothing

★ Protagonist of the Story - Vicky's Original Aspiration

- 27 years of deep experience in the tourism industry
- 17 years of commitment to sustainable tourism
- Witnessed the plight of the industry firsthand
- Determined to change the unfair rules of tourism



★ Story Development - Entrepreneurial Journey

- 2016, Brexit day → Entrepreneurial idea born
- 2017, UN International Year of Sustainable Tourism → Earth Changers officially launched
- 2020, COVID-19 strike → Expansion plan suspended
- 2022, tourism recovery → Faced a critical funding crisis

★ The core of the EC-- Three Principles

- Profits go to local communities first; finally platform takes commission
- Selected by merit, no advertising or listing fees
- Every trip aligns with UN Sustainable Development Goals



★ Example: EC Partner Project — Nikoi Island (Indonesia)

- A fully sustainable resort built on an uninhabited island
- Bamboo construction, zero waste, water recycling
- Hire local staff, support communities, protect marine ecology
- EC selects sustainable destinations without paid promotion and directs travelers to book locally to keep all economic value in the community



★ Hard truth: The Predicament of Six Years of Perseverance

- It has been in operation for a full six years
- No external financing has been obtained
- Personal savings have been exhausted.
- Subsidize the company with consulting income



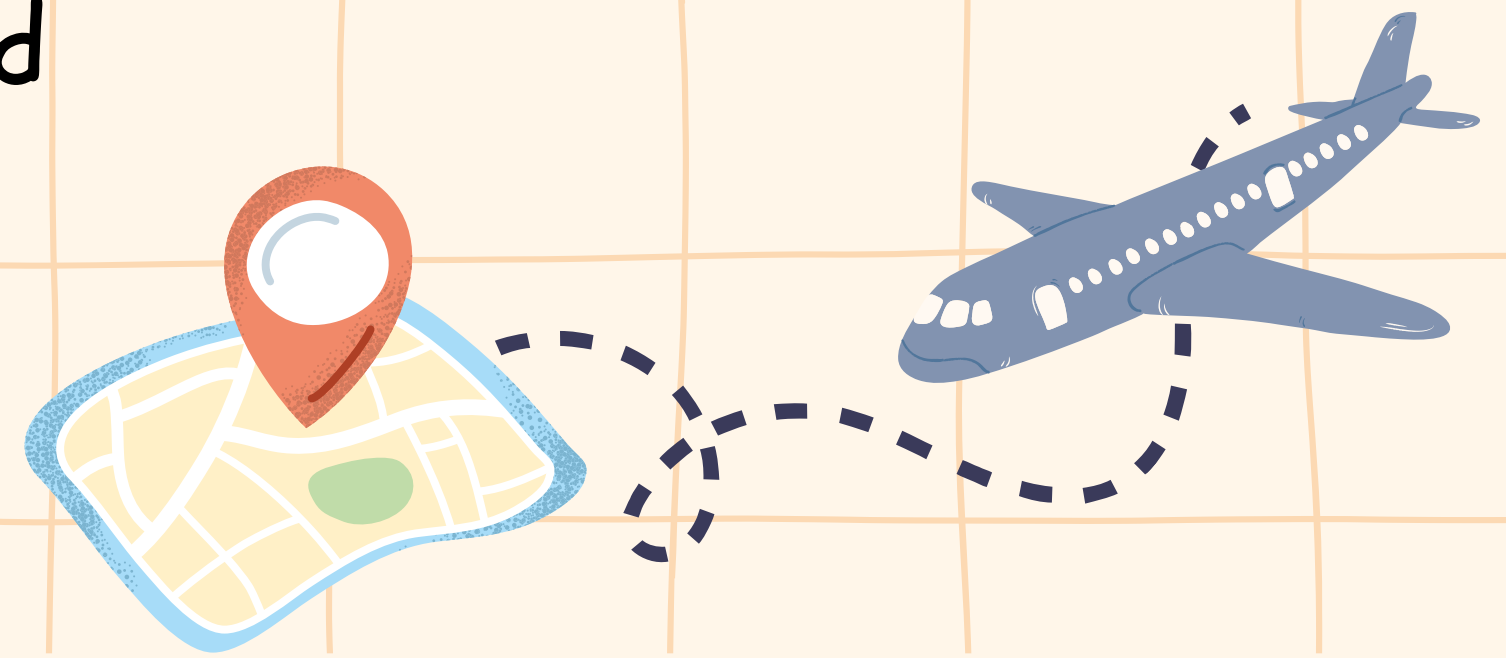
★ Core Vicky's Dilemma

- How to raise funds without losing the original intention of sustainability?



What We Will Discuss Today:

1. What are the personal and business challenges was Vicky Smith facing in 2022?
2. Develop Earth Changers' triple-layer business model canvas in July 2022.
3. Given Vicky was about to pitch to investors, summarise the distinctive features and challenges of Earth Changers' business model in 2022.
4. Supplementary case from Thailand – Tripseed
5. Doing exercise



Given Vicky was about to pitch to investors, summarise the distinctive features and challenges of Earth Changers' business model in 2022.



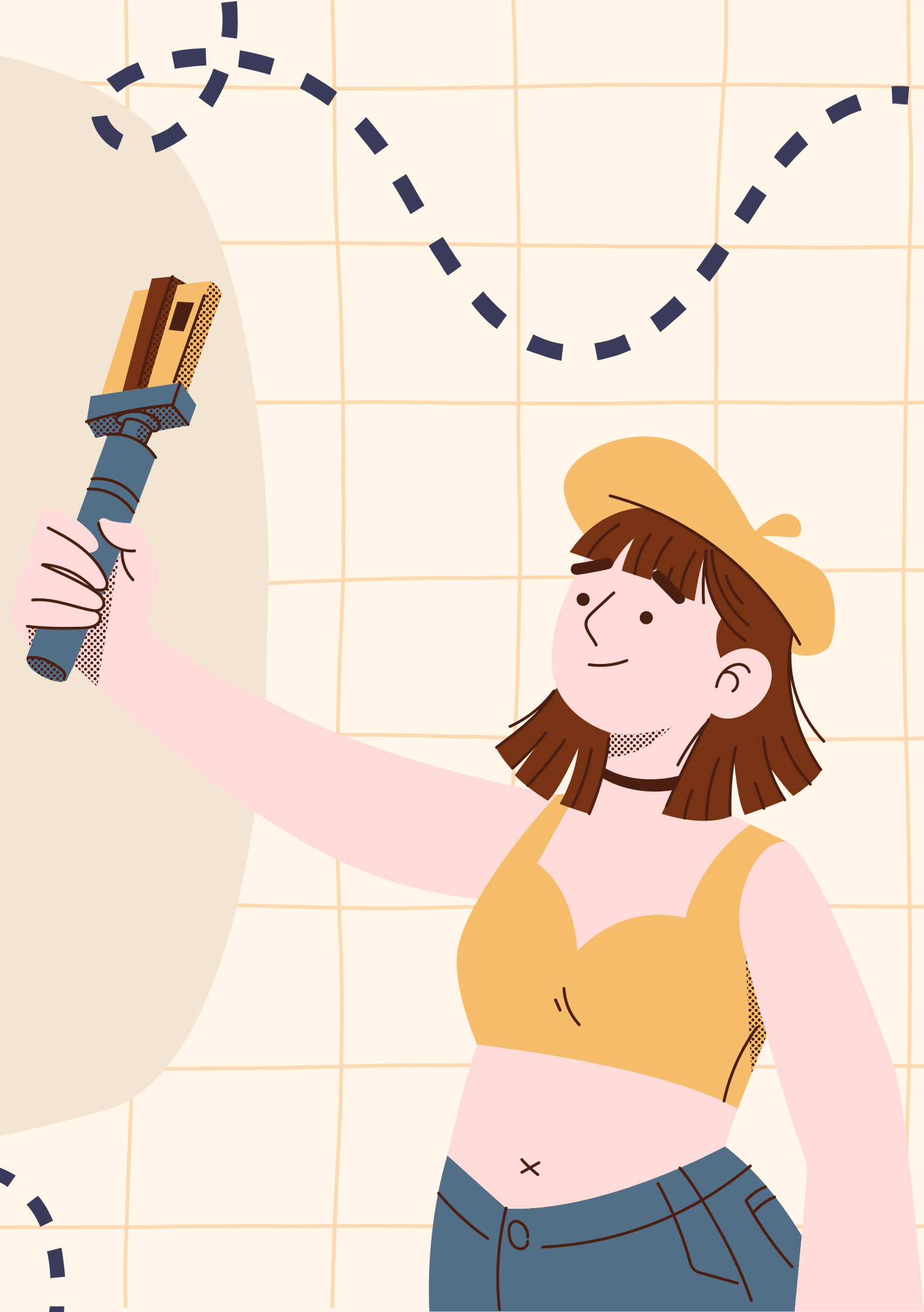
"Distinctive features" = "Moats & Investment Highlights"

1. What **first-mover advantage** does it have in the industry?
2. What is the essential **difference** between its revenue model and traditional OTAs like Booking/Expedia?
3. What **trust barrier** does it build?
4. **VRIO** Model Judgment Criteria¹: Valuable? Rare?
Inimitable? Organized?

Barney, J. B. (1991). Firm resources and sustained competitive advantage. *Journal of Management*, 17(1), 99-120.

Distinctive features

- the world's **first SDG** fully-bonded impact selection platform
- **Reverse commission model** with local priority
- Trust barriers of pure **influence** without paid membership



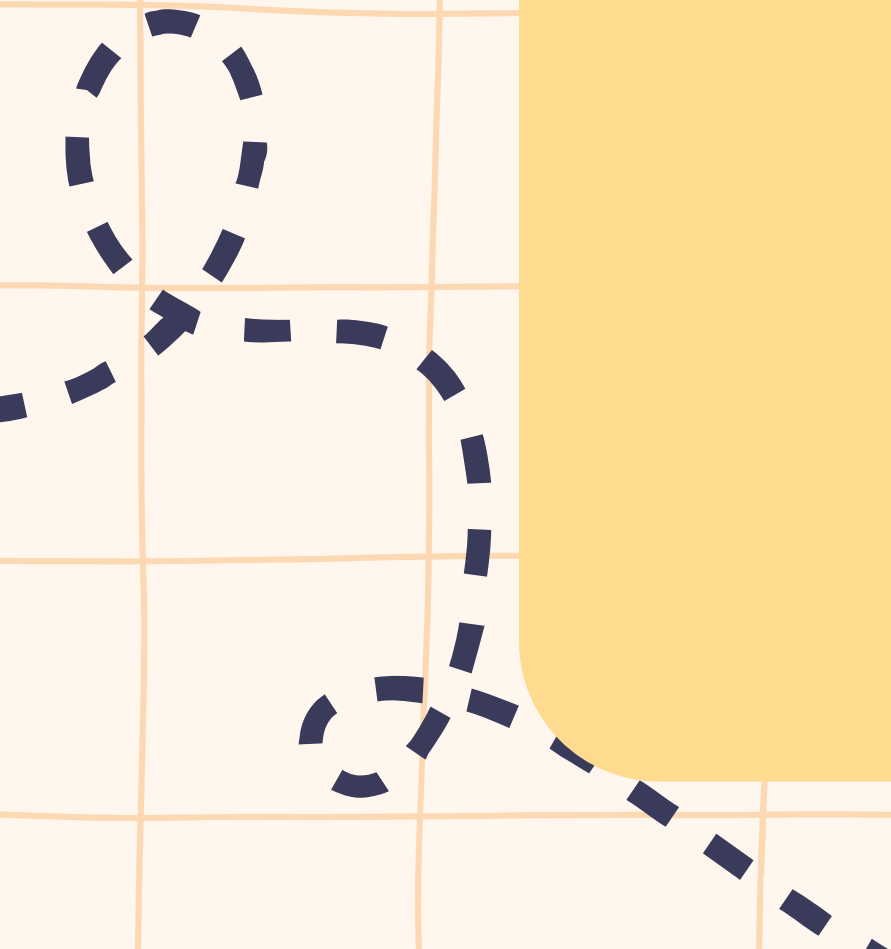
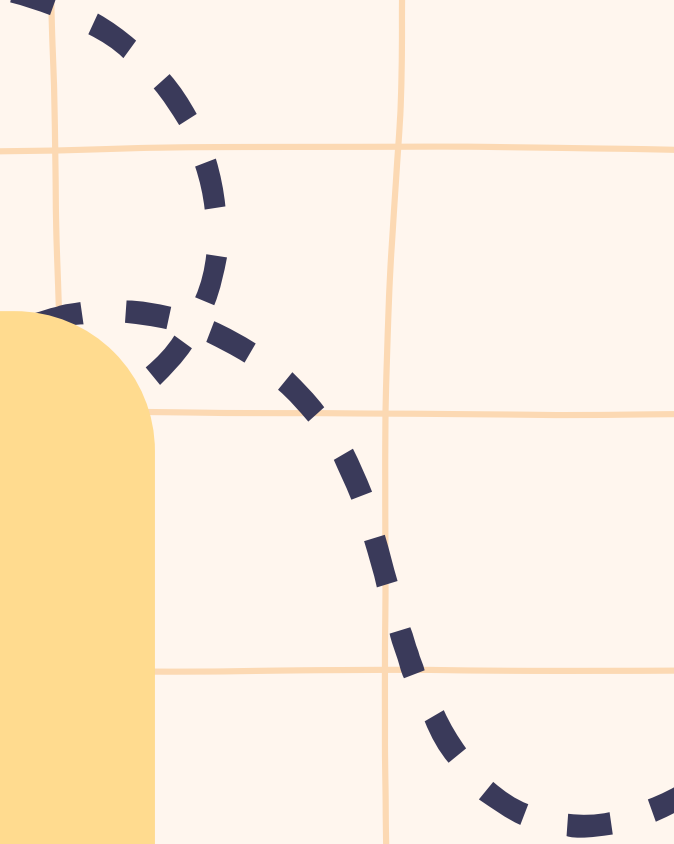


**What are the personal
and business challenges
was Vicky Smith facing in
2022?**





Personal Challenges





Personal Challenges

Financial pressure:

Savings nearly depleted, relying on consulting income

Working alone:

No co-founder or complementary team

Fundraising frustration:

Lack of investor support and perceived bias

Mission tension:

Balancing capital needs with keeping the mission



"Business Challenges" = "Fundraising Deal-Breakers & Risks"



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SP Model

People

Solo founder with no team → limited execution

Product

Weak model → no cash flow control or data ownership

Potential Market

Niche market (~1%) → low demand conversion

Performance

No historical data, no revenue → no validation

Potential Upsides

No clear scale or exit → uncertain returns

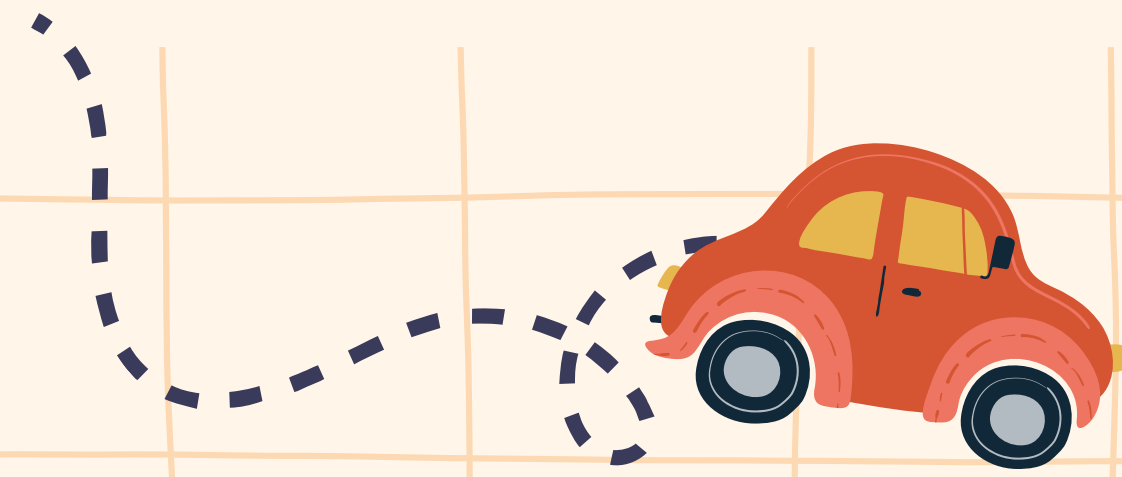




**Develop Earth Changers'
triple-layer business
model canvas in July
2022.**



Triple-layer business model canvas (TLBMC)



Core Concept: Extends the traditional **Business Model Canvas (BMC)** by adding two layers to comprehensively evaluate how an organization generates multiple types of value—economic, environmental, and social.

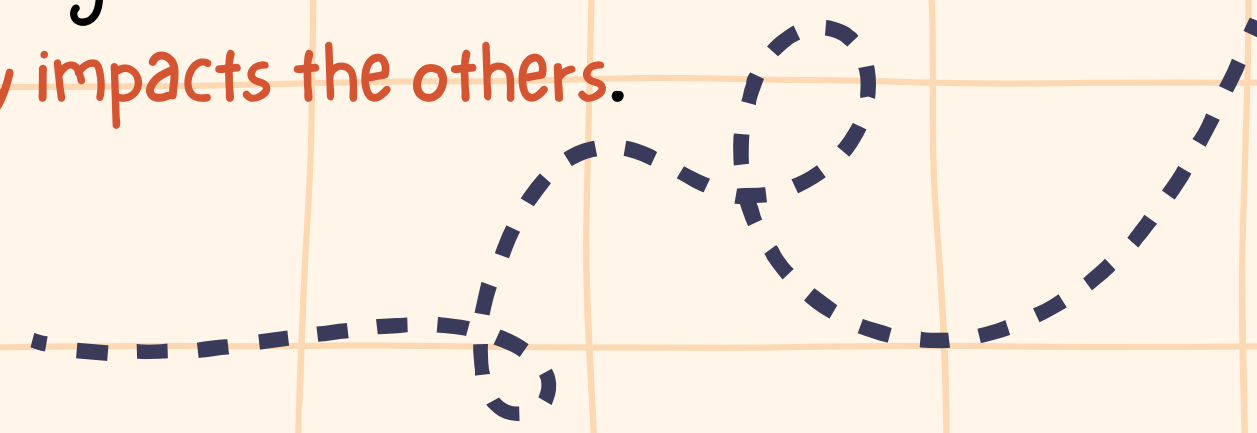
The three Layers

1. **Economic Layer:** Focuses on **financial viability**—how a business creates, delivers, and captures economic value.
2. **Environmental Layer:** Built on a **Life Cycle Perspective**, assessing ecological impacts and benefits from **supply chain and production** to **end-of-life**.
3. **Social Layer:** Built on a **Stakeholder Perspective**, measuring the holistic impact on employees, local communities, and society.

Key Dynamics

Horizontal Coherence: The **logical consistency** and **integration** within the nine components of each individual layer.

Vertical Coherence: The **alignment** across the three layers, revealing how an action or decision in **one layer directly impacts the others**.



The Economic Layer



<u>Partners:</u>	<u>Activities:</u>	<u>Value Proposition:</u>	<u>Relationships:</u>
local operators	Strict verification	Sustainable alternative	Long-term
Strategic mentors	Verification of regenerated influence	Anti-Greenwashing	Sustainable awareness
NGOs	MKT&PR	<u>Customer Segments:</u>	<u>Channels:</u>
	<u>Resources:</u>	Value-driven travelers	Official website
	Vicky's 21 years reputation	High net-worth conscious travelers	Association recommendations
	destination database	Seeking authentic experience	Social media
<u>Costs:</u>			
Operational Overhead	financing challenge(M&A)	Compliance fees	



The Environmental Layer



<u>Supplies and Outsourcing:</u>	<u>Production:</u>	<u>Value Phase:</u>	<u>Extend Supply Chain:</u>
Intellectual-Driven production	Sustainable matching services	Guiding low-carbon consumer behavior	Amplifying impact
Low-Carbon supply standards	Driving change in tourism	Offsetting impact through strategic advocacy	Commercial growth&ecological restoration
Green infrastructure optimization	<u>Material:</u>	<u>End-of-life:</u>	Allocation platform
	Minimal direct material	Physical erasure of digital assets	
	Massive embodied life-cycle consumption	Compliant e-waste recycling	
<u>Environmental Impact:</u>	<u>Environmental Benefit:</u>		
Annual carbon footprint reduced 51.56%	Parnters:e.g. zero-resource-burden operations	Regenerative investment	

Social Stakeholder Layer

<u>Local Communities:</u>	<u>Governance:</u>	<u>Social Value:</u>	<u>Societal Culture:</u>	<u>End-User:</u>
Local communities are primary beneficiaries	Mission-driven	Empower local communities	Promotes cultural preservation & awareness	Conscious travelers
<u>Employees:</u>	purpose-first	fair distribution of tourism income	<u>Scale of Outreach:</u>	
Very lean structure (founder-driven)			Currently limited reach	
<u>Social Impacts:</u>		<u>Social Benefits:</u>		
Limited accessibility (niche market)		Income redistribution	Community empowerment	



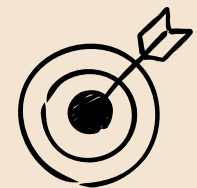
Horizontal Coherence

Economic Layer: weak

- Value proposition
- Revenue capture
- Customer relationship

Environmental Layer: moderate

Social Layer: strong



Vertical Coherence

Alignment: Revenue Model ↔ Social Value

Value Proposition ↔ Environmental Goals

Conflict: Profit vs Impact

Growth vs Sustainability



About the exercise :

- Use the PEACH and APPLE frameworks to score Earth Changers and apply matrices to determine the company's positioning. (Detailed explanations will follow.)
- Give reasons. (2-3 minutes)



The Orchard Test

- Developing solutions to systemic problems (PEACH)
- Building organisations capable of scale and impact (APPLE)

t1_2526 Understanding Social Entrepreneurs.pptx P54



PEACH

Proximity to the problem to understand how the system is broken

Empathy: possess an abiding 'can't do' empathy to find a solution

Audacity to propose an innovative and transformative system change

Capability to develop something that is truly needed

Humility to admit mistakes and pivot the solution

APPLE

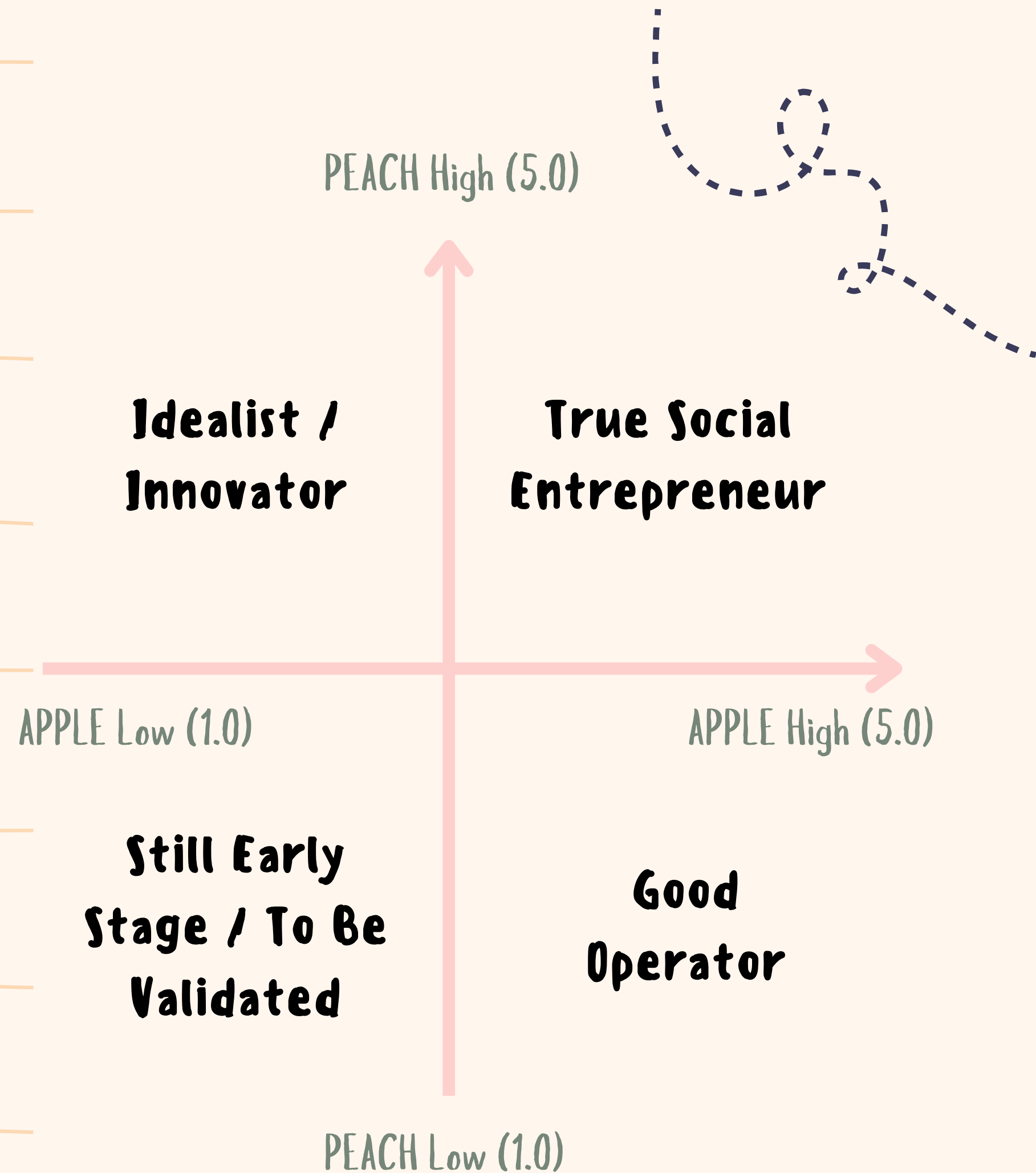
Ambition to build something important that can deliver system-wide impact

Persuasion to attract funding in a crowded marketplace of ideas

Persistence to take no for an answer and keep going

Legitimacy to convince stakeholders to take you seriously

Energy to build something out of nothing





Has anyone ever
succeeded in doing
what Vicky wanted
to do?



Tripseed

A Mirror Solution Reference for Earth Changers

- Small, locally owned travel intermediary established in 2021
- Design & deliver ethical travel experiences for overseas travel agencies (DMC mode)

While ensuring that tourism revenue truly remains in the Thai local economy.

How?

LEGAL LOCK-IN

DATA-DRIVEN TRANSPARENCY

CUSTOMER SEGMENT

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE



CUSTOMER SEGMENT

Scarcity of funds

B2B Nature



Stable cash flow

- **↑ Average Transaction Value**
- **Stronger customer loyalty and long-term relationships**
- **↓ Marketing + customer acquisition costs**



Ownership Structure

Personalized Trust Dilemma

- **Replace** "personalized trust" with **"structured trust"**

Third-party audit

- SEWF "People and Planet First"

— Worldwide recognizability (Over 130 countries)

(Keyser, 2026)

Verifiable and objective sources of trust



"Right" Representative

- 70% owned by locals (Cluckie, 2025b)

Their own community, their own stake

Legal Lock-in of the Social Mission

Impact Dilution

Regarding Vicky's concern that "what if investors come and I have to compromise?"

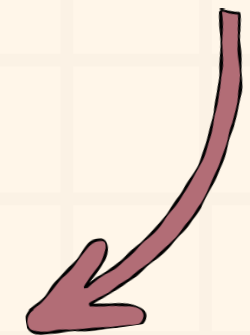
- Contractual Stipulations

— **At least 50%** of the annual profits **must** be reinvested in social justice and environmental protection projects.



Legal effect and can be enforced

Filter out the right investors



Ensuring long-term social impact and SE operations

Economic Distribution Disclosure Initiative(EDDI)

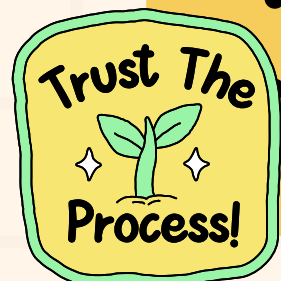
- **First** in the tourism industry **The Brand Moat**

— Over 80 tourism projects have been tagged with their geographical economic distribution.

Economic Leakage

Where did your money go?

- XX% directly benefited specific regions where tourism occurred.
- XX% were allocated to broader provincial regions.
- XX% were allocated at the national level.
- XX% were allocated overseas.



Credibility

Likeability

POD/competitiveness



Economic Distribution Disclosure Initiative (EDDI)

Expand influence

- **Publicly disclose** corporate income tax data
- Analyzed 17 major licensed tourism operators and DMCS
(In units of 100 THB) (Thailand's Department of Business Development)



- Tripseed: THB 2.36
- Sampled uncertified companies' average: THB 1.13
- Sampled Travelife Partner average: THB 0.76
- Sampled B-Corporation certified average: THB 0.60
- Sampled Travelife Certified companies: THB 0.00

(Cluckie, 2025)

→ Top $\frac{2}{3}$ contributors do not have sustainability certification

→ Certification $\neq$ true social contribution

Breaking Industry Conventions

Creating industry-wide standards

Drive industry transformation

Thank You



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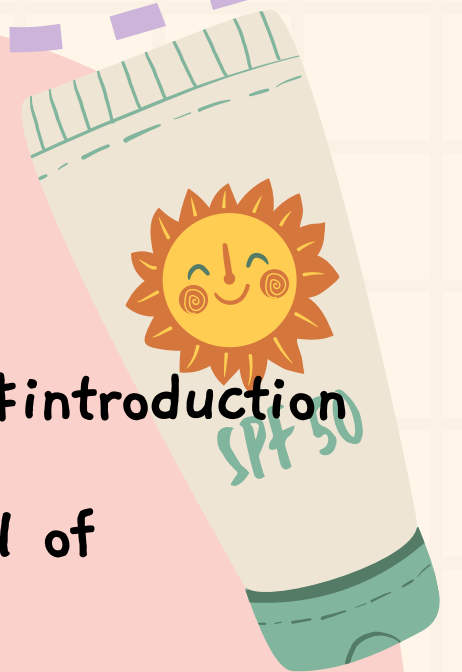
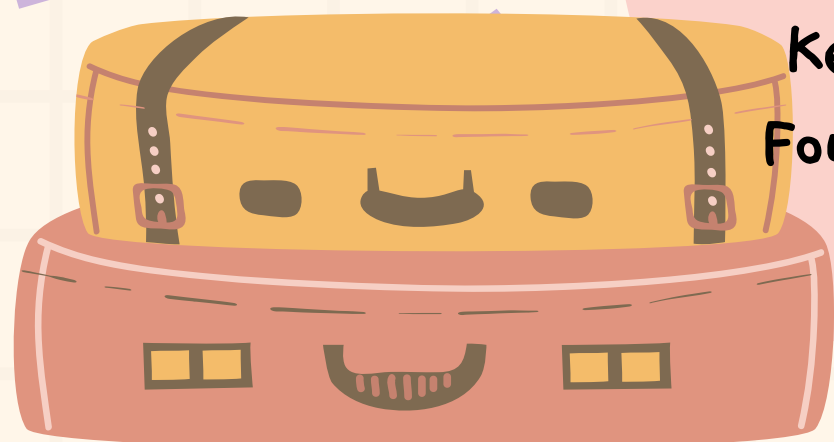
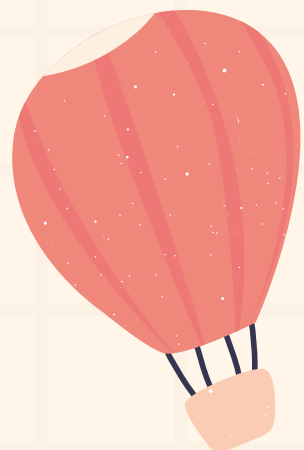
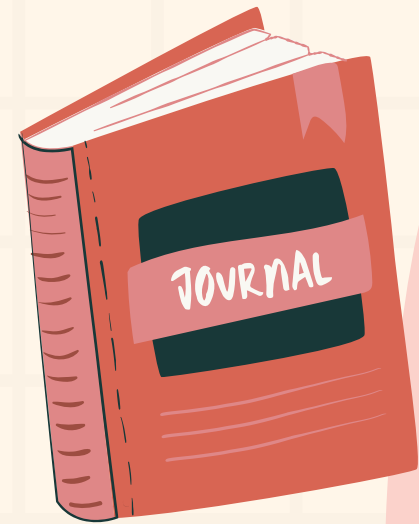
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